

Advanced English (C1 Advanced)

A 13-week, 26-class English course for adults whose English is already fluent and who now need precision, nuance, and control, for university, professional life, or their own satisfaction. Twice a week for 90 minutes, you refine advanced grammar and vocabulary, read arguments critically, write essays, reports, and professional emails, follow lectures, lead seminars, and finish by writing and defending a position paper. Between classes, the free online lessons (with audio) are your homework.

LEVEL	DURATION	EACH CLASS	CONTENT
CEFR C1 · Advanced	13 weeks · 26 classes	90 minutes · 2 × week	8 modules · 24 lessons

CLASS SCHEDULE

Two classes a week, 90 minutes each. Every class has **one lesson** from the online course, except the two assessment classes. The skills lessons (critical reading, essay and report writing, lectures and note-taking, seminars) run as **workshops**. Lessons 4.3 and 8.3 are **review projects**: a persuasive talk with a register shift at the halfway point, and a position paper and its defense at the end. ✓ = the can-do goal for that class.

WEEK 1

Precision in Time & Certainty

Module 1: placing events exactly in the future, and dialing certainty up or down.

C1

1.1

Advanced Aspect — The Future in Detail

will be doing · will have done · will have been doing · was going to, was about to, would · the tactful *Will you be joining us?*

✓ I can place future events precisely: in progress, completed, or seen from the past.

C2

1.2

Advanced Modality — Speculation & Nuance

may well vs may as well · *that'll be* · should for expectation · the many jobs of *would* · must have been doing

✓ I can signal exactly how certain I am, about the present and the past.

WEEK 2**Unreal Worlds**

Modules 1–2: the subjunctive, then conditionals that cross time.

C3 1.3 The Subjunctive & Unreal Uses

I recommend that she be... · that he not resign · were I in charge · as if he owned the place · be that as it may

✓ I can make formal proposals and describe imagined situations.

C4 2.1 Advanced & Mixed Conditionals + Alternatives to “if”

past → present, present → past · if + should / were to · provided that, unless, in case, even if · but for

✓ I can analyze the what-ifs of a decision and set precise conditions.

WEEK 3**Emphasis & Focus**

Module 2: turning grammar into rhetoric, and steering the listener’s attention.

C5 2.2 Inversion for Emphasis & Style

Never have I... · Not only did... · No sooner... than · Had I known / Should you require · So great was...

✓ I can use inversion for emphasis, and judge when it earns its place.

C6 2.3 Cleft Sentences & Fronting for Cohesion

It was... that · What I need is... · The reason... is that · fronting · given before new, end-weight

✓ I can spotlight, correct, and connect ideas across a paragraph.

WEEK 4**Academic Style & Cohesion**

Module 3: the nominal style of formal writing, and the threads that tie a text together.

C7 3.1 Nominalization & Academic Style

decide → decision · carry out an investigation · pose a threat · the passive and “there is” · avoiding over-nominalization

✓ I can move a text into academic register, without making it airless.

C8 3.2 Cohesion — Reference, Substitution & Ellipsis

this trend, such a move · the former / the latter · one, do so, I think so / I hope not · I’d love to

✓ I can write and speak without clumsy repetition.

WEEK 5**Diplomacy & Multi-word Verbs**

Modules 3–4: softening with purpose, then phrasal verbs and their register.

C9

3.3

Hedging, Vague Language & Diplomatic English

the evidence suggests · I was wondering if... · not exactly ideal · preface → soften → reason · eight-ish, or so

✓ I can soften a claim, a request, or bad news without hiding my message.

C10

4.1

Phrasal Verbs & Multi-word Verbs

four types · turn it off, look after them · take off (three senses) · put off vs postpone · a breakdown, an outcome

✓ I can choose between a phrasal verb and its formal synonym on purpose.

WEEK 6**Word Choice & a Halfway Project**

Module 4: collocation, idiom, and connotation, then the first review project.

C11

4.2

Collocation, Idiom & Connotation

heavy traffic, meet a deadline, deeply concerned · a blessing in disguise · slender vs skinny · purchase / buy / pick up

✓ I can choose the exact word for the partner, the feeling, and the occasion.

C12

4.3

Review Project — The Advanced Communicator

the register spectrum · rhetorical devices · signposting a talk · one point, two voices · Modules 1–4 in action

✓ I can give a persuasive talk and restate it formally and informally.

WEEK 7**Halfway Check & Compressed Clauses**

Module 5: a progress test, then participle and absolute clauses.

C13

TEST**Progress Test 1 (Modules 1–4) + Catch-Up**

~58-min written check · 8-min pair speaking · catch-up stations

✓ I know what I do well and what to refine.

C14

5.1

Participle & Absolute Clauses

Realizing the risk,... · Having signed... · Written in 1920,... · The weather being fine,... · the dangling participle

✓ I can compress clauses for formal writing and keep every participle anchored.

WEEK 8**The Small Words & the Formal Word**

Module 5: dependent prepositions, then academic vocabulary.

C15

5.2**Advanced Prepositions & Prepositional Phrases**

comply with, aware of, an increase in · with regard to, in the event of, on behalf of · comply with vs conform to

✓ I can use dependent prepositions and formal prepositional phrases accurately.

C16

5.3**Academic & Formal Vocabulary**

get → obtain, show → demonstrate · Academic Word List families · suggest, argue, demonstrate · don't over-formalize

✓ I can raise the register of my writing through precise word choice.

WEEK 9**Reading Critically & Building an Essay**

Module 6: taking an argument apart, then building one.

C17

6.1**Critical Reading — Evaluating Arguments & Bias**

fact vs opinion · claim, evidence, warrant · loaded language · false cause, cherry-picking, false dilemma · asserts, concedes, downplays

✓ I can evaluate an argument and name its strengths and weaknesses.

C18

6.2**Academic & Argument Writing — Structuring an Essay**

an arguable thesis · hook → context → thesis · PEEL paragraphs · concede → rebut · a conclusion with no new points

✓ I can plan and write a well-structured argument essay.

WEEK 10**Professional Writing & Lectures**

Modules 6–7: writing that works at work, then following extended talks.

C19

6.3**Professional & Formal Writing — Reports, Emails & Applications**

purpose first · polite but direct requests · findings → recommendations · evidence + relevance in a cover letter

✓ I can write a clear professional email, report, or application.

C20

7.1**Understanding Lectures & Talks — Following & Note-taking**

signposting · main idea vs detail · predicting and stance · keywords, symbols, hierarchy · the Cornell layout

✓ I can follow a lecture and capture its structure in notes.

WEEK 11**Delivery & Seminars**

Module 7: the music of English, then managing a group discussion.

C21

7.2**Pronunciation & Intonation for Fluency**

sentence stress and weak forms · thought groups · fall, rise, fall-rise · contrastive stress · linking

✓ **I can use stress, pausing, and intonation to make my meaning clear.**

C22

7.3**Seminar & Discussion Skills**

Could I just come in here? · Building on what you said... · So if I understand you correctly... · So where does that leave us?

✓ **I can take part in and help steer a seminar discussion.**

WEEK 12**Fluency & the Editor's Eye**

Module 8: thinking on your feet, then editing for concision.

C23

8.1**Fluency & Spontaneity — Speaking Strategies**

That's a good question... · the thing you use to... · or rather... · useful vs reflexive fillers

✓ **I can keep talking coherently under pressure, even when a word escapes me.**

C24

8.2**Precision & Concision — Editing Your English**

due to the fact that → because · very tired → exhausted · make a decision → decide · write, then cut ten percent

✓ **I can edit my own writing to say more with fewer words.**

WEEK 13**The Position Paper & the Finish Line**

Module 8: the capstone defense, the final test, and a celebration.

C25

8.3**Review Project — A Position Paper & Its Defense**

thesis → arguments → counter-argument → rebuttal → conclusion · conceding without collapsing · the whole C1 toolkit

✓ **I can write a position paper and defend it under questioning.**

C26

TEST**Final Test + Celebration**

~60-min written test · ~10-min individual speaking interview · certificates

✓ **I can show what I can do in English.** 🎉

EVERY CLASS, THE SAME SHAPE

0:00	Warmer & review of the last class A speaking task that recycles last class's language
0:10	Input & analysis A text, talk, or model · meaning, form, register & pronunciation
0:30	Focused practice Drill the key forms, then workbook tasks checked with a partner
0:50	<i>Break (5 min)</i>
0:55	The main task A seminar, debate, writing lab, editing workshop, or presentation
1:20	Feedback & “I can...” Accuracy, range & appropriacy · peer review · tick the can-do checklist
1:25	Homework set-up The online lesson with  audio + one workbook page

COURSE DETAILS

■ Prerequisites

- ◆ **CEFR B2.** You can tell a layered story, argue a case and handle disagreement, switch between formal and informal English, follow fast natural speech, and write a formal email and a balanced argument.
- ◆ Finished **Confident English (B2)**? You're ready. New to our program? Take the shared **placement test** first.
- ◆ Learners whose reading and writing lag behind their speaking are welcome. Every lesson has support options, and the tests have an adapted version.
- ◆ No computer needed in class. A phone or computer helps for homework, but it isn't required.

■ What's Provided

- ◆ A **Student Workbook** for all 24 lessons, in natural C1 English (the learner keeps it)
- ◆ A **welcome handout** with seminar and peer-review ground rules, what to bring, and QR codes to the online lessons
- ◆ For the teacher: a **Teacher's Guide** (a 90-minute plan for every class), slides, flashcards, role-play and seminar cards, lecture scripts, games, and answer keys
- ◆ Free access to the companion online course: Advanced English (C1), with  audio
- ◆ A free learning-tools page that shows how to translate lessons into any language

■ Assessment

- ◆ **Every class:** an “I can...” checklist and feedback on the main task, with no grades
- ◆ **Class 13 • Progress Test 1** (Modules 1–4): listening, vocabulary, grammar rewrites, reading, a formal recommendation, and an 8-minute pair speaking task
- ◆ **Class 26 • Final Test** (all 8 modules): a mini-lecture with note-taking, critical reading, use of English, a structured essay or report (about 250 words), and a 10-minute individual interview with a long turn, a discussion with push-back, and a diplomatic register task
- ◆ Rubrics follow the CEFR C1 descriptors. Results decide the **next class**, never who gets to celebrate
- ◆ Tasks about your life can always use a “**new identity**” or an imagined example, and in debates you may argue an **assigned side** instead of your own view

■ Homework & the Online Course

- ◆ After each class, do the matching **online lesson** at home: about **40–60 minutes**, with 🎧 Listen buttons for model sentences, dialogues, and talks
- ◆ Plus one **workbook page**, and a little reading in English every day
- ◆ Missed a class? The online lesson covers the same language, so you can catch up
- ◆ After the course: **Mastery English (C2)** completes the same free ladder. IELTS Academic Preparation and Business English can run alongside

What You'll Be Able to Do

By the end of the course, learners reach **CEFR C1** and can use English flexibly and effectively for social, academic, and professional purposes:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ✓ Place events precisely in time and signal exactly how certain you are | ✓ Make formal proposals with the subjunctive and analyze what-ifs across time |
| ✓ Use inversion, clefts, and fronting for emphasis and cohesion | ✓ Write in an academic register without losing clarity, and link a text smoothly |
| ✓ Soften claims, requests, and bad news diplomatically, and choose words by register | ✓ Compress clauses and use prepositions and academic vocabulary accurately |
| ✓ Read arguments critically and write structured essays, reports, and professional emails | ✓ Follow a lecture, take structured notes, and use stress and intonation to carry meaning |
| ✓ Take part in and steer a seminar, and keep talking coherently under pressure | ✓ Edit your own writing for concision, and write and defend a position paper |

